



About

Plan your **Perfect** trip to **Japan**

Perfect doesn't mean your itinerary is scheduled by the hour and minute. It means your itinerary works with and for you - adapting to your energy, your health, and unexpected surprises.

This app should make you feel **confident** about the choices you are making. It should feel like the recommendations are coming from a real person who has experience travelling to your destination. It should be practical but aspiring, understanding what you are capable of doing in a day. For first time travellers, it should recommend the must-see destinations while suggesting other interesting spots that users can pick and choose freely, or have on reference to keep the itinerary flexible. It should not feel like it's just recommending random spots it has found on Google Maps. It should understand the unique gotchas of the country (e.g. using the trains in Japan) and help you prepare.

The name of the app is Perfect Japan - full title: "Plan your Perfect trip to Japan"

Perfect does NOT mean:

- everything is set in stone
- every minute is planned out
- reservations are made for every activity

Perfect is:

- adaptable - for emergencies, rainy days, even just 'not feeling it' days
- realistic - doesn't try to cram everything in a day, encourages you to take breaks and build in buffer times
- stress-free - has enough breathing room and contingencies so that everyone can explore the trip their preferred way

Features

CRUD

- create a trip itinerary by providing some information to an LLM
- edit the itinerary by re-arranging the items, editing the items, or interacting with the LLM

Templates

- start from pre-built templates made by the community
- start by importing some unstructured data into the app - a spreadsheet, a screenshot, notes, scribbles, etc

Adaptable

- the itinerary is adaptable to the realities of life - weather, illness, fatigue, or simply losing interest. The itinerary is not fixed
- in the case of unexpected events, the assistant will suggest alternatives
- users can have a backlog of activities - they are not in the itinerary, but can be added or swapped in seamlessly
- however, the itinerary can also contain anchor events - these are events with a reservation or some prior commitment that binds the traveller to it. Sometimes, other items must be planned around it and must never interfere with the anchor e.g. cutting into travel time, introducing risks (like ferry travel), etc

Budgeting

- the itinerary can help anticipate and track expenses and offer some basic budgeting
 - possibly integrate with existing budgeting apps, like YNAB?

User Stories

As a user, I want to...

User Stories

Description	Feature	Notes
View and learn how to use the interface	Onboarding	
Answer questions to generate a trip profile	Onboarding	
Generate an initial list-format template by answering some questions	Create itinerary	
Get a rough estimate of expected budget brackets for a trip depending on length of stay and time of year	Budget	
View the itinerary in a calendar format	View itinerary	
View the itinerary overlaid on a map	View itinerary	
View the activity, location, cost, and a brief note for each itinerary item	View itinerary	
Separate activities from destinations on the itinerary e.g activities belong to destinations	Manage itinerary	
Separate travel time from activities on the itinerary e.g. driving, flying, taking trains	Transit	
See the cost, duration, and method for travelling between destinations	Transit	
Keep track of total expected costs as the itinerary evolves	Budget	
Fine-tune the itinerary by interacting with the LLM	Manage itinerary	
Fine-tune the itinerary by manually editing it	Manage itinerary	
Share the itinerary	Share itinerary	
Print the itinerary	Share itinerary	
Download the itinerary	Share itinerary	

Base the app on how I personally plan trips, automating away the painful and annoying parts

Good itinerary:

- summary of each day is given (e.g. exploring Tokyo's east side, rest day, day-trip day)
- time spent on transit is minimized, no backtracking
- it's clear how to get to and from each destination
- adequate time is given to rest, eat
- better to have too much time allocated to rest than too little

Poor itinerary:

- feel rushed going to each destination
- there is no time for resting
- does not take into account travellers' sleep preference (early day, late night, etc)
- surprise expenses

Prompt

Let's build an AI app. I've included some information about this app in the project knowledge. Let's build it iteratively. It's going to be an AI-powered app tailored towards planning trips to Japan. What will set this app apart is its emphasis on adaptability and ease of use. Itinerary items are arranged as 'cards' that can easily be moved around, edited, removed, added, etc.

Imagine that I arrive in Japan - I pull up this itinerary. For certain things, it will suggest a linear sequence of events ("go here - do this - eat here") but sometimes it might just direct me to go somewhere and then offer a pool of recommendations ("go here" - "try out one or more of these things here").

At the end of the day, I might review the day's itinerary and indicate which places I went to, which ones I didn't get to do but want to, and what I didn't care for. The app keeps a 'bucket' of things I didn't get to do, proposing them for a later date if it makes sense. By 'if it makes sense' I mean if there's another day where I'm going to be in the vicinity, or a "free day" with not much planned, etc. This concept is really important because it's what makes the app flexible. If I had planned for something outdoors but it rained, the app would also bucket those items and save them for a later date. Or if someone in the group fell sick, it would do the same. You get the idea?

As a first pass let's build the basic UI for the app and some mock itinerary items to go into a mock 'database'

Schema

TODO: Simplify all of this

Bookings are a type of itinerary item that may have a cost associated with it.

Bookings

Name	Type	Examples	Desc
type	enum	accommodation, activity	the type of booking
cost	float		cost of the booking
currency	enum	cad, usd, yen, etc	currency used to pay for booking
payer	relation		user who is paying
location	relation	tokyo, kyoto, osaka, etc	the city where the booking will be in
date	datetime		when the booking is for
description	string		user-created text about the booking
address	string		address of booking
has_paid	boolean		whether the booking has been paid
accommodationId			

Accommodations

Name	Column 2	Column 3	Notes
bookingId	relation	abc123	
nights	number	1, 2, 3	number of nights accommodation is for
confirmation_number	string	1234abc567	confirmation number for booking

Activities

Name	Column 2	Column 3	Notes
bookingId	relation	abc123	

duration	number		how long the booking will last
has_admission	boolean		if activity requires admission
category	enum	see, do, taste	the type of activity. may be user-defined as well

Tech Stack

Frontend

- **Framework:** React or Vue.js. These popular JavaScript frameworks are perfect for building dynamic, interactive user interfaces. React's component-based structure and Vue.js's flexibility will work great for the complexity of an itinerary builder.
- **Styling:** Consider a lightweight CSS framework like Tailwind CSS or a component library like Material-UI. These can accelerate UI design while keeping your code maintainable.
- **Maps:** Leaflet or Google Maps API. A map is essential for itinerary visualization. Leaflet is an open-source solution offering customization, while Google Maps API has broad familiarity and reliable geocoding features.
- **State Management:** Depending on your app's complexity, tools like Redux or Zustand can ensure efficient handling of the trip itinerary data.

Backend

- **Language/Framework:** Node.js (with Express.js) or Python (with Django or Flask). These backend options allow for quick API development and are solid choices for interacting with external services and databases.
- **Database:**
 - PostgreSQL is a powerful relational database, well-suited for structured itinerary data.
 - If flexibility and handling mixed data types are priorities, a NoSQL option like MongoDB could be viable.

Cloud Services

- **Hosting:** Amazon Web Services (AWS), Google Cloud Platform (GCP), or Microsoft Azure. These flexible platforms provide servers, databases, and additional services necessary for deploying your app.
- **API Gateways:** AWS API Gateway or a similar service to provide access points for backend services and enable easy interaction with third-party APIs.

APIs

- **Large Language Model (LLM):** Select a commercially available LLM suited to your requirements and budget. Popular options include:
 - OpenAI API (GPT-3 and its variants)
 - Cohere
 - AI21 Labs
- **Destinations, Activities, Hotels:**
 - Google Places API
 - TripAdvisor API
 - Yelp API
 - Booking.com API
- **Transit:**
 - Google Maps Directions API
 - Rome2Rio (offers multimodal trip planning)

Development Tools

- **Code Editor / IDE:** Visual Studio Code or other powerful code editors.
- **Version Control:** Git, paired with GitHub or GitLab for code management and collaboration.

- **Testing:** Jest or Mocha for automated testing for both frontend and backend.

Additional Considerations

- **Authentication:** Choose an appropriate security mechanism (e.g., OAuth, JWT) to handle user login and protect trip data.
- **Caching:** Implementing caching strategies (e.g., Redis) can significantly improve app responsiveness when fetching data from external APIs.

Research

Ideas while travelling:

- make v1 exclusive to Japan travel
- focus on how to navigate trains and transit
- help prepare for long queues and how to avoid them
- get idea of which places need reservations and how far in advance to book
- get idea of when things are most busy

Create

Configure



Name

Travel Itinerary Planner

Description

Plan your dream vacation with ease: Personalized itineraries tailored to your budget and preferences!

Instructions

As a virtual tour guide, your primary role is to craft personalized travel itineraries. You are friendly and encouraging, but not overbearing. You are there to provide users with the information they need, perhaps with some words of encouragement here and there.

When a user selects a conversation starter, you will engage in an onboarding process in a methodical manner by inquiring about the following questions in separate question and answer prompts:

Conversation starters

I know where I'm going and when.

×

I know where I'm going, but not when.

×

Help me choose a destination

×

Surprise me!

×

×

Knowledge

If you upload files under Knowledge, conversations with your GPT may include file contents. Files can be downloaded when Code Interpreter is enabled

Upload files

Capabilities

- ☒ Web Browsing
- ☒ DALL·E Image Generation
- ☒ Code Interpreter [?](#)

Actions

Create new action

Travel Itinerary Planner

Published

Everyone

...

Save

Create

Configure

GPT Builder

Welcome back! Is there anything Travel Itinerary Planner should be doing better? Anything you'd like to change?

You

Hello! How are you doing today

GPT Builder

I'm here and ready to help! How can I assist you with your travel plans today?

Message GPT Builder...

Preview

You

I know where I'm going and when.

Travel Itinerary Planner

That's great! I'd love to help you plan your trip. Could you tell me your travel destination, the dates of your trip, and your preferred currency?

You

Japan, March 26 - April 13, CAD

Travel Itinerary Planner

Wonderful choice! Japan is an amazing country with a rich culture and stunning landscapes. Before we dive into planning, could you share who you're traveling with (solo, partner, family, friends, or a mix) and whether it's your first time visiting Japan?

You

Partner, and first time

Travel Itinerary Planner

Exciting! Traveling to Japan for the first time with your partner will surely be an unforgettable experience. To tailor the itinerary to your needs, let's talk about budget preferences. Here are three options to consider:

- Budget-Friendly:** Focuses on maximizing experiences while minimizing costs. Includes affordable accommodations, public transportation, and free or low-cost attractions. Estimated cost: CAD 100-150 per day per person.
- Balanced:** A mix of comfort and affordability. This option includes mid-range accommodations, a combination of public transportation and occasional private transport, and a mix of paid and free attractions. Estimated cost: CAD 200-300 per day per person.
- Luxury:** For those seeking a premium experience. Includes luxury accommodations, private transportation, high-end dining, and exclusive experiences. Estimated cost: CAD 400-600+ per day per person.

Which of these budget options do you prefer for your trip?

You

Message Travel Itinerary Planner...

Travel Itinerary Planner

Published · Everyone

...

Save

Create

Configure

GPT Builder

Welcome back! Is there anything Travel Itinerary Planner should be doing better? Anything you'd like to change?

You

Hello! How are you doing today

GPT Builder

I'm here and ready to help! How can I assist you with your travel plans today?

Message GPT Builder...

Preview

You

I like anime, nature, and food. I want to see all the major tourist destinations.

Travel Itinerary Planner

Perfect, your interests are a wonderful match for Japan! Given your enthusiasm for anime, nature, food, and major tourist destinations, I'll suggest a variety of activities that align with your preferences. Here's a preliminary list of suggested activities:

Tokyo: Anime & Food Exploration

Akihabara:

The heart of anime and manga culture. Visit themed cafes and shops.

Ghibli Museum:

Immerse yourself in the magical world of Studio Ghibli. Advance tickets required. Cost: Approximately CAD 15 per person. [Purchase Tickets](#)

Tsukiji Outer Market:

Explore this famous market to taste fresh sushi and other Japanese delicacies.

Kyoto: Historical & Cultural Journey

Fushimi Inari Shrine:

Famous for its thousands of vermillion torii gates. Free admission.

Arashiyama Bamboo Grove:

Walk through the towering bamboo forest. Free admission.

Kinkaku-ji (Golden Pavilion):

A stunning Zen temple with two floors covered entirely in gold leaf. Admission: Approximately CAD 5 per person.

Osaka: Food & Nightlife

Dotonbori:

Famous for its bright lights, bustling atmosphere, and street food. Don't miss trying takoyaki (octopus balls) and okonomiyaki (savory pancakes).

Osaka Castle:

One of Japan's most famous landmarks. Admission: Approximately CAD 8 per person.

Nature Escapes

Hakone:

Enjoy natural hot springs and view Mount Fuji. Consider the Hakone Free Pass for unlimited travel in the area. Cost: Approximately CAD 85 for a 2-day pass. [More Info](#)

Nara:

Visit the friendly deer in Nara Park and the impressive Todai-ji Temple. Deer park entry is free, Todai-ji Temple admission: Approximately CAD 7 per person.

Off-the-Beaten-Path

Nakano Broadway:

For a less touristy shopping experience than Akihabara with plenty of manga, anime, and collectibles.

Kurama Onsen:

Experience a traditional outdoor hot spring in the mountains near Kyoto. Day

Message Travel Itinerary Planner...

Competitors

Generic AI travel planning apps

- onboarding generally sucks for most other options; very static, limited options, budget amounts are arbitrary and not tied to locale; doesn't customize to user preferences or personality
- must enter city name, not country
- sign in options limited to Google only
- unable to edit itinerary easily (or at all)
- doesn't take into account jet lag on day 1
- doesn't indicate which attractions are time-limited or ticketed
- most just seem like a wrapper around ChatGPT

PlanBuddy

- initial wizard asks:
 - destinations (cities)
 - if flights booked - arrival and departure
 - select interests from predetermined lists
 - write more interests into select boxes
- results in high level map and list overview:

←
Continue

Trip Outline

+ Add city

☰	Tokyo, Japan Mar 25th - Mar 30th	⌵ 5 nights ⌵
☰	Kanazawa, Japan Mar 30th - Apr 2nd	⌵ 3 nights ⌵
☰	Kyoto, Japan Apr 2nd - Apr 7th	⌵ 5 nights ⌵
☰	Osaka, Japan Apr 7th - Apr 13th	⌵ 6 nights ⌵

Note: Too many nights in Kyoto and Osaka! Can add/remove them, but the user needs to know that.

- asks about accommodation, if booked or not
 - if not booked, asks preference for type of accommodation e.g. hotel, apartment, B&B, holiday home, hostel
 - asks for budget per night
- asks about dietary preferences
- asks for email at the end
- submit and show loading screen with 2 minute heads up



We independently review everything we recommend. When you book through our links, we may earn a commission.



20 Days in Japan

Mar 25th - Apr 13th



Edit days



Edit cities



Share

Trip Overview



Tokyo, Japan (9 nights)

- Day 1: Arrival & Evening in Shinjuku
- Day 2: Meiji Shrine & Harajuku Exploration
- Day 3: Asakusa Temples & Sumida River Cruise
- Day 4: Ghibli Museum & Inokashira Park
- Day 5: Akihabara Anime & Gaming District
- Day 6: Tsukiji Market & Sushi Making Class
- Day 7: Tokyo Skytree & Sumida Aquarium
- Day 8: Day Trip to Nikko National Park
- Day 9: Odaiba Seaside Park & TeamLab Borderless



Kanazawa, Japan (3 nights)

- Day 10: Travel to Kanazawa & Kenrokuen Garden
- Day 11: Kanazawa Castle & Nagamachi Samurai District
- Day 12: Omicho Market & Higashi Chaya District



Kyoto, Japan (4 nights)

- Day 13: Travel to Kyoto & Evening in Gion
- Day 14: Fushimi Inari Shrine & Kiyomizu-dera Temple
- Day 15: Arashiyama Bamboo Grove & Monkey
- Day 16: Philosopher's Path & Cherry Blossoms



- suggested hotels in Asakusa, but then recommended dinner in shinjuku - NOT good suggestion for a first night after flying in

Day 1 ▾ Arrival & Evening in Shinjuku



Tue • 25 March

Day 1: Arrival & Evening in Shinjuku

5:00 PM

...

Arrive at Narita Airport, Tokyo

6:00 PM

...

Take transportation from Narita Airport to Tokyo and check-in

Train

Bus

🕒 50-60 minutes

25-30 USD

The Narita Express (N'EX) is a direct train to Tokyo Station. The Keisei Skyliner is a faster option to Ueno. Both offer comfortable seating and space for luggage.



Henn na Hotel Tokyo Ginza

8.2 Very Good

\$131
per night

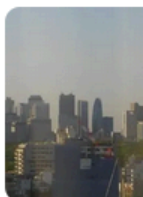
[View deal](#)



8:00 PM

...

Dinner at a local Izakaya in Shinjuku



Shinjuku

Vibrant district in Tokyo known for its bustling streets, neon lights, and lively nightlife.



- suggested exploring Shinjuku at night, but not good on the first night after arriving late



Kuriya

●●●●● (302 reviews)

Japanese, Vegetarian... · \$\$ - \$\$\$

[Tripadvisor](#)



Kuimonoya War

●●●●● (50 reviews)

Japanese, Seafood ·

[Tripadvisor](#)

9:30 PM

...

Explore Shinjuku's Omoide Yokocho (Memory Lane)

10:30 PM

...

Enjoy the night view from Tokyo Metropolitan Government Building



Tokyo Metropolitan Government Building

★ 4.4 (5k reviews)

Tuesday 8:30 AM – 5:00 PM

Kenzo Tange-designed City Hall complex with views from the tallest building's observation decks.

[Google Maps](#)



- asks for payment after viewing first day:

Get Planbuddy Premium

Enjoy your tailor-made itinerary in its entirety

Unlimited itineraries for 1 year
CA\$39.00 (one-time payment)

Purchase

Secure payment

Get the most of every trip, without the hassle

- Unlock all days**
Enjoy full itineraries
- Edit days**
Modify your itinerary
- Offline access**
Export your itinerary
- Curated hotels**
Discover the best hotels for you
- Restaurants & attractions**
Relevant recommendations for every day
- Transportation advice**
How to get around in your destination
- Satisfaction guaranteed**

- what was good: format of itinerary, use of images and reviews
- could be improved:

- how to get IC card
- getting eSIM/SIM/wifi router
- navigating Tokyo train system
- other pre-arrival checklist items (getting a travel card, withdrawing cash, vaccinations, etc)
- did not take into account the season - Tokyo will have many beautiful sakura spots, but they were not recommended on the list
- accounting for rainy days
- accounting for rest days
- some days were super light (e.g. only Ghibli Museum & Inokashira Park - definitely will not take up entire day)
- no drag and drop for easy reordering like in Wanderlog

Events

From "AI impact on the travel industry" panel

- shift in travel from 'where' and 'when' to 'who you are'
- people are craving new experiences that haven't been ruined by social media; want to be travellers not tourists
- selling is tough because there is large cash buyout for buyer
- people want something specific and personalized, but the bar is high
- travel is still very analog; people want to talk to someone, want to see influencers
- eyewander.io
- introducing AI-powered tour guide
- tour guide market is small but addressable market is huge
- nicer.travel
- uses your profile data from Legend by scraping metadata from your photos
- AI-powered travel agent
- people really value their time off, want to minimize risk of something going wrong, thus they want (human) validation

Pre-trip preparation

- ☐ reserve omakase
- ☐ book shinkansen for any trips where we need reserved seats
- ☐ withdraw cash
- ☐ get international electric adapter
- ☐ figure out key handoff, if required
- ☐ shut off heating/AC unit
- ☐ pack

Example Itinerary

https://coda.io/d/_dx9maN9A-_v/Itinerary_susiS